In *Chaos*, Tom O'Neill details how Whitson's role at the Tate crime scene was the ultimate "fixer" job, and how his career spanned the darkest corners of 20th-century intelligence.

The "Clean-Up" at Cielo Drive:
According to O'Neill's interviews with Whitson's associates (including cinematographer Richard Edlund and friends of Jay Sebring), Whitson allegedly removed items to prevent a "scandal within a scandal":

- **Large Quantities of Drugs:** Witnesses claimed Whitson removed high-grade narcotics (cocaine and MDA) to protect the reputation of the victims and their Hollywood circle, ensuring the "official" story focused on the killers rather than a "drug party gone wrong."
- **Surveillance Equipment:** Whitson was known to have bugged the homes of his "friends." O'Neill suspects he removed his own listening devices to hide the fact that the **CIA was already monitoring the house** when the murders occurred.
- **Compromising Photos/Film:** There have long been rumors of "snuff films" or pornographic tapes involving celebrities at the house. Whitson's associates hinted he removed visual evidence that would have destroyed the careers of several living stars.

Whitson's "Vast and Strange" Global Ties:
O'Neill discovered that Whitson was not just a Hollywood hanger-on; he was a bridge between the CIA and far-right international networks.

- **The Nazi Connection (Otto Skorzeny):** Whitson was a close associate of **Otto Skorzeny**, Hitler's favorite commando who later became a key figure in the **Paladin Group** (a white-supremacist mercenary organization). O'Neill found it "incomprehensible" that a man embedded with Hollywood liberals was also working with high-level Nazis.
- **The Presidential Campaign (Curtis LeMay):** Whitson worked on the 1968 vice-presidential campaign of **General Curtis LeMay** (the hawk who inspired *Dr. Strangelove*). O'Neill argues this shows Whitson's alignment with the "Old Guard" who wanted to crush the 60s counterculture.
- **The Shah of Iran:** Whitson acted as a private security liaison for the **Shah's family**. This gave him access to "diplomatic" channels that allowed him to bypass U.S. law enforcement, explaining why the LAPD never questioned him.
- **Operation CHAOS & COINTELPRO:** O'Neill concludes Whitson was the "connective tissue" between the **FBI's COINTELPRO** (which targeted the Black Panthers) and the **CIA's Operation CHAOS**. By keeping Manson on the streets, Whitson potentially helped create a "monster" that would make the Black Panthers and hippies look like villains to the American public.

O'Neill's research, summarized in the Los Angeles Review of Books, suggests Whitson was a man who lived in the "cracks" of the law, moving between **MKUltra scientists**, **Nazi mercenaries**, and **Hollywood royalty**.

Would you like to see the **specific evidence** O'Neill found linking Whitson to the **intentional framing** of the Black Panthers for the Manson murders?

In *Chaos*, Tom O'Neill argues that the framing of the Black Panthers was not just a random whim of Manson's, but a tactic that perfectly aligned with the goals of intelligence operations like **Operation CHAOS** and **COINTELPRO** to discredit and "neutralize" radical movements.

The Mechanics of the Frame-Up:
O'Neill details how Manson directed his followers to leave specific "signs" that would lead police and the public to blame Black militants:

- **Mimicking Panther Rhetoric:** At the murder scenes of Gary Hinman, Sharon Tate, and the LaBiancas, the Family used the victims' blood to write phrases such as **"Political Piggy," "Death to Pigs,"** and **"Rise."** "Pig" was a specific term popularized by the Black Panthers to describe law enforcement and the establishment.
- **The "Panther Paw":** During the Hinman murder, Manson explicitly told Bobby Beausoleil to leave a sign; Beausoleil responded by painting a **Panther paw print** on the wall in blood to shift blame to the Party.
- **The Bernard Crowe Incident:** O'Neill highlights that Manson's paranoia—and his "race war" narrative—intensified after he shot drug dealer Bernard Crowe, whom he *believed* was a Black Panther. Manson used this fear to convince his followers that the Panthers were coming for them, necessitating "pre-emptive" strikes to start the war first.

The Whitson & Intelligence Connection:
O'Neill's theory suggests that Reeve Whitson and his superiors may have facilitated or "steered" this framing to achieve their own political ends:

- **Strategic Alignment:** The CIA's Operation CHAOS and the FBI's COINTELPRO were actively working to provoke conflict between radical groups. By allowing a group of "hippies" to commit murders that looked like Panther hits, the government could turn the public against both movements at once.
- **The Spahn Ranch "Invitation":** O'Neill uncovered surveillance records showing that in 1968, Manson **invited Black Panthers to Spahn Ranch**. He posits that this was an attempt to infiltrate or further link the two groups, potentially under the guidance of monitors like Whitson.
- **Coerced Testimony:** O'Neill discovered that Whitson and prosecutor Vincent Bugliosi allegedly **coerced witnesses**, such as Sharon Tate's photographer Shahrokh Hatami, to ensure the official "Helter Skelter" (race war) narrative remained the focus of the trial, effectively cementing the image of the "Black threat" in the public mind.

According to the Los Angeles Review of Books, O'Neill's ultimate suggestion is that the Manson Family acted as an **unwitting tool** for the very agencies tasked with tracking them.

Would you like to see the **FBI memos** O'Neill found that discussed "lining celebrities up against the wall" months before the Tate murders?

In his book *Chaos*, Tom O'Neill describes a November 1968 FBI memo discovered within COINTELPRO files, which discussed a strategy of psychological warfare aimed at Hollywood celebrities. The memo proposed making liberal celebrities understand they would be "lined up against the wall with everyone else" during "the revolution," suggesting it was meant to terrify the wealthy into withdrawing support for radical movements. O'Neill notes this memo circulated months before Sharon Tate and Jay Sebring, figures associated with that social circle, were murdered. You can read more about O'Neill's findings at Rolling Stone.